

Efficacious Concepts Provisioned Wholesale by
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Use "Sensu" Today:
sort your scope out
and get concept-clarity!



” SENSU ”
A TAXONOMIC TERM TO HELP
FIGHT RSE-DEFINITION
CONFUSION!

github.com/FlicAnderson/sensu-IRSC26

YOU MAY HAVE EXPERIENCED CONFUSION

ABOUT THE TERM:

" RESEARCH
SOFTWARE
ENGINEER "
(RSE)

Who are RSEs, and how can they be identified?



You may have heard people discussing:

- ❖ Inclusive definitions (US-RSE / Society of RSEs)
- ❖ Activity-based definitions
- ❖ Motivation-based definitions

Perhaps even YOU could be an RSE?

Can you be SURE?

Is "Sensu"
Right For You?



DOES YOUR WORK ASK...

What do we know about RSEs?

How can we support them?

What challenges do RSEs face?

DO YOU AIM TO FIND OR ENGAGE WITH
THEM IN YOUR WORK...

... but struggle to clarify

'which type' of RSEs

your project addresses?

PROPOSING "*SENSU*"

'Sensu' is a Latin word
meaning "in the sense of"

*Used in various and diverse fields e.g. biological
taxonomy for the avoidance of confusion, to:*

*... specify Scope or Source
of Concepts or Names*

"Sensu lato":

"in the **broad** sense (s.l.)"

... RSE (s.l.) as inclusive umbrella term;

from scientist-coders to Research Software
specialists and everyone in-between!

"Sensu stricto":

"in the **strict** sense (s.s.)"

... RSE (s.s.) for narrower cases,

e.g. full-time job role providing computational
support for academics



Sensu can also be *combined* with an *authority* or *source*!

For example:

"... RSE sensu US-RSE ..."

"... RSE sensu Goth et al."

BENEFITS:

- *Avoid confusion* amidst many RSE definitions!
- *Find* the kind of RSEs you're looking for!
- *Save time and energy!*



Adoptees say:

"Sensu" frees us to use our skills to address the challenges faced by RSEs of **ALL Definitions!**

Use "sensu" today in your discussions about RSEs, and *feel the difference* it makes in every conversation!

For more information about using "sensu", please consult a local taxonomist or Flic Anderson for details.

” SENSU ”: (TL; DR)

Helps your audience understand **exactly which RSEs** your guidelines, policy, research findings or participation invitations are designed to benefit:

Use "sensu lato" for the **broader**, more inclusive umbrella term (e.g. "RSE s.l.).

Use "sensu stricto" when trying to communicate a **narrower** concept (e.g. "RSE s.s.).